



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Planning, Research and Development Branch Guide for the Conduct of Meetings

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1.0 Introduction

The Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) has placed increased emphasis on ‘*Improving Communication & Public Engagement*’ through among other things, transformation of systems and processes geared to: i) better understanding the needs and expectations of stakeholders; ii) strengthening stakeholder engagement thus building relationships; and iii) increasing citizens’ voices and choices in maintaining a robust citizen safety and security ecosystem.

One of the most effective method of understanding the interests, needs and expectations of stakeholders is through the conducting of meetings. A meeting is a planned coming together of people whether physically or virtually for formal discussion. This document provides a summary guide for the conduct of meetings in the JCF.

2.0 Guidelines

The following presents a summary guide for the conduct of meetings. The following guidelines are published for reference when engaging stakeholders for meetings:

2.1 The role of the meeting Chair

Every meeting convened by the JCF and/or its representatives must have a meeting Chair who shall be responsible for efficiently managing its proceedings. The following guidelines will be observed:

- 2.1.1 Notice of meeting must be communicated to all interested parties and agenda provided if practicable;
- 2.1.2 Ensure there is a designated minute-taker;
- 2.1.3 Where applicable, ensure minutes of previous meetings are circulated, read, corrected and confirmed;
- 2.1.4 Manage the affairs of the meeting;
- 2.1.5 Adjournment of the meeting;
- 2.1.6 Ensure current minutes are distributed to the relevant parties for them to be agreed upon; and
- 2.1.7 Communicate to the relevant people/institutions about decisions finalized at the meeting.
- 2.1.8 Ensure that where applicable, follow-up tasks are executed

3.0 The role of Secretary/Minute-taker

Every meeting must have a minute-taker. This is usually the role of the secretary and in the absence, any person so appointed. The minute-taker is required to:

- 3.1 Take notes that accurately summarizes the discussions and decisions made during the meeting;
- 3.2 Write up the notes in an agreed format (whether electronically or hard copy) so that information can be easily discerned and communicated;
- 3.3 Indicate the responsibilities and ownership of tasks/action agreed on during the meeting;
- 3.4 Copy and distribute the minutes to all relevant persons; and
- 3.5 Group and file minutes appropriately for ease of retrieval.

4.0 Prior to the meeting

- 4.1 Make arrangements for the meeting place to include hospitality for attendees;
- 4.2 Send adequate notice of the meeting to all interested parties about:
 - i. The type of meeting to be held;
 - ii. place, date and time of the meeting; and

- 4.3 If not already circulated, minutes of the most recent related meeting distributed to members;
- 4.4 Ensure required and/or outstanding reports are prepared/collected and printed or electronically distributed where practicable;
- 4.5 Arrange for guest speakers (when necessary); and
- 4.6 Formulate and distribute meeting agenda.

5.0 The Agenda

Unless marked confidential, the agenda and all supporting documents are to be made freely available to all guests. An agenda should contain the following standing items, however may vary according to the level of formality required:

- 5.1 Call to Order;
- 5.2 Chair's Welcome and Opening Remarks;
- 5.3 Roll Call;
- 5.4 Confirmation of receipt, reading and correction of the minutes of the last related meeting when applicable;
- 5.5 Confirming correction of the Minutes;
- 5.6 The required documents/reports;
- 5.7 Topics to be discussed, by whom, and allotted time;
- 5.8 A period for new businesses raised to be discussed;
- 5.9 Date of follow-up meeting where required; and
- 5.10 Adjournment.

Depending on the type and nature of the meeting, a prepared agenda may not be practicable.

6.0 Minutes

- 6.1 The minutes must note the attendances including names, positions, time of arrival, contact information, time of departure and non-attendances (excused, absence and apologies for absence);
- 6.2 The main points discussed and decisions made must be recorded;
- 6.3 The minutes must be presented for approval;
- 6.4 Any amendment to the minutes of the last meeting must be seconded and discussed prior to approval
- 6.5 When storing the minutes, copies of any correspondence tabled, attendance sheets and a copy of the notice should be attached.

7.0 After the Meeting

- 7.1 Ensure the minutes of the meeting are distributed in a timely manner;
- 7.2 Ensure Task Owners complete assigned tasks/projects by the agreed date; and
- 7.3 Update the relevant stakeholders of the progress made on assigned tasks.